EDI via FTP/VPN, SFTP, FTPS

When protocols like FTP/VPN, SFTP and FTPS are used for exchange of EDI based documents through the Internet or Intranet it is called as EDI via FTP/VPN, SFTP, FTPS.

Web EDI

Web based EDI conducts EDI using an web browser via the Internet. Here the businesses are allowed to use any browser to transfer data to their business partners. Web based EDI is easy and convenient for small and medium organizations.

Mobile EDI

When smartphones or other such handheld devices are used to transfer EDI documents it is called as mobile EDI. Mobile EDI applications considerably increase the speed of EDI transactions.

18.3 Advantages of EDI

EDI was developed to solve the problems inherent in paper-based transaction processing and in other forms of electronic communication. Implementing EDI system offers a company greater control over its supply chain and allow it to trade more effectively. It also increases productivity and promotes operational efficiency. The following are the other advantages of EDI.

- Improving service to end users
- Increasing productivity
- Minimizing errors
- Slashing response times
- Automation of operations
- Cutting costs
- Integrating all business and trading partners
- Providing information on process status
- Optimizing financial ratios

18.4 EDI Layers

Electronic data interchange architecture specifies four different layers namely

1. Semantic layer
2. Standard translation layer
3. Transport layer
4. Physical layer

These EDI layers describes how data flows from one computer to another. See Figure 18.3

<table>
<tr><td>EDI Semantic layer</td><td colspan="2">Application level services</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">EDI Standard translation layer</td><td colspan="2">EDIFACT business form standards</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">ANSI X 12 business form standards</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="3">EDI Transport layer</td><td>Electronic mail</td><td>X.435, MIME</td></tr>
<tr><td>Point to point</td><td>FTP. TELNET</td></tr>
<tr><td>World Wide Web</td><td>HTTP</td></tr>
<tr><td>Physical layer</td><td colspan="2">Dial-up line, internet, I-way</td></tr>
</table>

Figure: 18.3 EDI Layers

18.5 EDI Components

There are four major components of EDI. They are

1. Standard document format
2. Translator and Mapper
3. Communication software
4. Communication network

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